CA INTERMEDIATE · GROUP II · SHORT NOTES

The *Firm*

Four desks, one signature. Cost, audit, treasury, boardroom.

You are in articleship, rotating through the four desks that Group II actually examines. Every topic here is traced to **ICAI's own syllabus PDFs**, downloaded on 10 September 2026 and kept in `syllabus-pdfs/` so you can check any claim against the source. Nothing outside the syllabus is taught, and every answer is sealed until you have attempted it — because reading a

solution and producing one are not the same skill, and only one of them is examined.

4	300	149
PAPERS	MARKS	TRACKED TOPICS

24	49,429
SEALED ATTEMPTS	WORDS

Read this before the notes

Three things decide whether short notes help you or quietly hurt you. All three are

printed in ICAI's syllabus itself, and all three are easy to ignore.

STUDY GUIDELINES RULE

ICAI states for every paper that the **specific inclusions and exclusions in each topic are set every year by way of Study Guidelines**. These notes cannot know your attempt's exclusions. Pull the Guidelines for your sitting and cross off what is out.

STANDARDS MOVE

For Auditing, ICAI states that if new legislation or Standards on Auditing replace existing ones, the syllabus automatically picks up the new provisions from a notified date. Verify every SA number against the current Study Material before you rely on it.

NOTES ARE SECOND

Short notes are for *revision and recall*, not first learning. They are a compression of the ICAI Study Material, and compression loses exactly the worked detail that carries marks. Read the module first; come here to keep it.

PASS MARK

40 in every paper and 50% in aggregate — 150 out of 300 for Group II, with nothing below 40. The aggregate rule is why a strong Paper 4 can carry a shaky Paper 5, and why no paper can be abandoned.

FORMATS EARN MARKS

In Paper 4 the cost sheet, reconciliation and variance layouts are marks in themselves. In Paper 5 the Standard's own vocabulary is the mark. Write formats out by hand until they are automatic; that is what the sealed gates are for.

VERIFY, DON'T TRUST

These notes were assembled against the syllabus, not the full Study Material. Where a number, section or Standard reference matters, the notes say so and tell you to confirm it. Treat any unflagged specific as needing one check.

The four desks

In ICAI's paper order. Papers 4 and 5 are 100 marks each; Paper 6 is split 50 for Financial Management and 50 for Strategic Management.

4

The Costing Desk

Cost and Management Accounting

WRITTEN

Why: The most numerical paper in the group, and the most reliably scoring one if the formats are automatic.
Concepts: Cost sheets · material and employee cost · overheads and ABC · reconciliation · job, batch, process and service costing · standard costing variances · CVP and marginal costing · budgetary control

---

5 The Audit Desk

Auditing and Ethics

WRITTEN

Why: Theory-heavy and language-sensitive: marks come from using the Standard's own vocabulary.
Concepts: SA 200 · SA 300 planning · risk and materiality (SA 315, 320, 330) · evidence (SA 500, 501, 505, 510, 520, 530, 550, 610) · audit of items · SA 230 · completion (SA 450, 560, 570, 580, 260, 265) · reports (SA 700, 701, 705, 706, 710, CARO) ·

entities · banks · ethics (SA 210, 220, SQC 1)

6A The Treasury Desk

Financial Management

WRITTEN

Why: Formula-dense but bounded: the same dozen formulas answer most of the paper.
Concepts: Ratio analysis · sources of finance · cost of capital and WACC · capital structure theories · leverages · payback, ARR, NPV, IRR, MIRR, PI · dividend models (Walter, Gordon, MM) · working capital cycle · receivables, payables, cash

6B The Boardroom

Strategic Management

WRITTEN

Why: Shortest syllabus in the group and the easiest to score on with clean, framework-led answers.

Concepts: Vision, mission, goals, values · strategic levels · PESTLE · Porter's Five Forces · value chain and PLC · Mendelow · SWOT · generic strategies · Ansoff, ADL, BCG, GE matrices · digital transformation · structure and culture · strategic control

Every desk

PHASE 4

The Costing Desk

Cost and Management Accounting. Cost sheets, material and employee cost, overheads, the four methods of costing, and the three control techniques — standard costing, marginal costing and budgets.

PHASE 5

The Audit Desk

Auditing and Ethics. Eleven units from the nature of audit through risk, evidence, documentation and the report — anchored on the Standards on Auditing the syllabus names, and closing on professional ethics.

11 sections 11 attempts 18,900 words

PHASE 6A

The Treasury Desk

Financial Management. Ratios, sources of finance and cost of capital, capital structure and leverage, investment appraisal and dividend policy, and the working capital cycle.

4 sections 4 attempts 11,262 words

PHASE 6B

The Boardroom

Strategic Management. Strategic intent and levels, external and internal analysis, the choice of strategy and the matrices that structure it, then implementation, control and performance measures.

5 sections 5 attempts 10,437 words

The Firm · CA Intermediate Group II · syllabus traced to icai.org (https://www.icai.org/post/syllabus-nset-intermediate), source PDFs in `syllabus-pdfs/` · not affiliated with ICAI